How much to let it do, and the capstone

Where each kind of work sits between “helps a person” and “runs on its own”, then your turn.

60 min | Recorded | Class 15 of 15

15

What this session covers

01
How much to let it do
3 slides

02
The capstone
3 slides

03
Closing
3 slides

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Section 1 of 3

How much to let it do

Four levels, and most work stops at the second.

01

Four levels of autonomy, each with an example from LOL

02

What changes in the job, and what doesn't

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Four levels of autonomy, each with an example from LOL

Assist	It suggests; a person does everything. Drafting the reply to BUM about the Santos delay
Co-pilot	It does the work; a person checks each result. Customs document fixes, payroll variance write-ups
Supervised agent	It runs; a person approves the risky steps and watches the numbers. Customs holds end to end, with the send behind approval
Autonomous	It runs; a person looks at samples. Replying to “has the InvoiceHub batch finished?”

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The level depends on **what a mistake costs**, not on how good the model is.

Supplier bank changes, payroll, and anything that sends money or a customs submission stay at co-pilot or below.

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What changes in the job, and what doesn’t

Changes

- Less looking things up, more checking answers
- Writing test sets and owner cards becomes normal work
- Knowing when to say “this doesn’t need AI”

Doesn’t

- Someone owns every outcome
- Customers still call when it goes wrong
- Judgement on the hard 10% stays with people

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Section 2 of 3

The capstone

Place a problem nobody's seen, and argue for the cheapest thing that works.

01

Each team gets one problem, or brings its own, and 25 minutes

02

The one-page proposal has six boxes, and "no AI needed" fits in all of them

03

Problems for the draw

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Each team gets one problem, or brings its own, and 25 minutes

1

Write it as one sentence

2

Answer the six questions from class 2

3

Place it on the card

4

Fill in the blank proposal

5

Present in 3 minutes

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The one-page proposal has six boxes, and “no AI needed” fits in all of them

The problem	One sentence, with a verb.
Where it lands	The place on the card, and the question that decided it.
Steps	Five at most. What gets built, in order.
Error budget	What one wrong answer costs, and how many we can live with.
Cost	To build, and to run per month.
Owner and off switch	Who answers for it, and how it gets turned off.

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Problems for the draw

1. Match B.U.M.'s EUR receipts to invoices automatically, net of bank charges
2. Tell dispatch which trucks will miss their slot at Felixstowe tomorrow
3. Answer drivers' payslip questions in their own language
4. Flag supplier emails asking for bank changes before anyone reads them
5. Summarise every customs hold for the weekly ops review
6. Predict which warehouse Wi-Fi access point fails next
7. Book visitor passes from a meeting invite
8. Decide which background check results need a second look

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Suggested placements, for after the presentations: 1 rule plus classical ML; 2 classical ML; 3 LLM with retrieval, co-pilot; 4 rule plus a classifier, person in the loop; 5 LLM with a prompt; 6 not yet, then anomaly detection; 7 a script; 8 not for any AI tool: ASS Restricted data.

Section 3 of 3

Closing

Fifteen classes on one card.

01

The whole track, on one card

02

What to do after the track

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The whole track, on one card

1. A script	**The steps are known and don’t change.**
2. A rule	**The decision is known and must be explainable line by line.**
3. Classical ML	**Labelled history, and the input is a table or short text.**
4. A small trained model	**Lots of text, images or audio, enough labels, cost per call matters.**
5. An LLM with a prompt	**Varied language in and out, few labels, someone checks the output.**
6. An LLM plus retrieval, tools or agents	**Needs private knowledge, has to act, or takes several steps.**
7. Not yet	**No ground truth, needs a guarantee, or nobody owns the result.**

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The **cheapest option** that stays inside the error budget wins.

Most of the time it’s a script, a rule or a small model. When it’s an LLM, it’s one with a test set, an owner and an off switch.

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What to do after the track

1. Take one problem from your team through the six questions this week.
2. If it needs AI, write the owner card before anyone writes code.
3. Everything is in the repo: decks, code, data, runbooks.

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